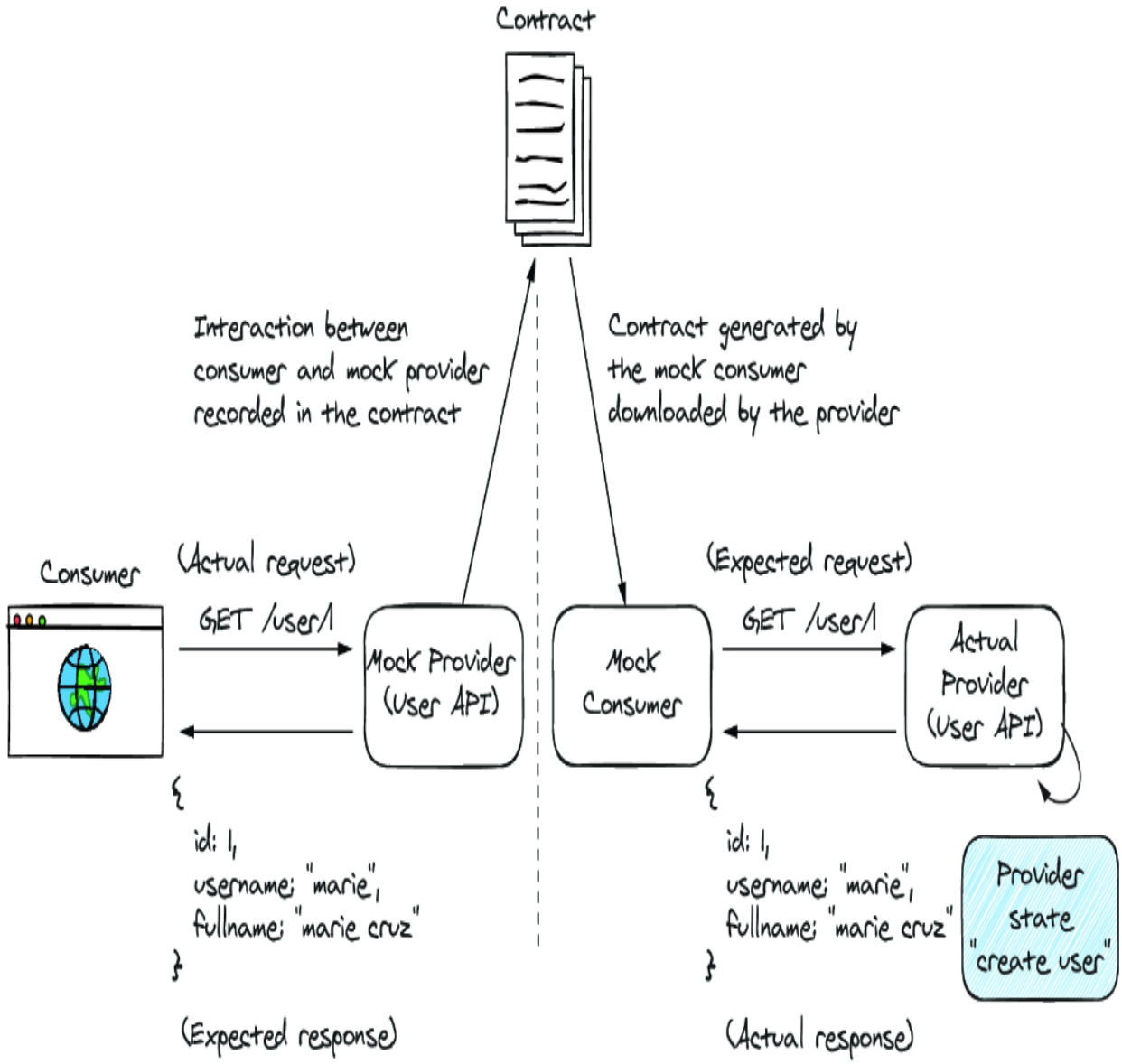


Figure 4.2 The important role of provider states in contract testing. Provider states are useful when the consumer expects providers to be in a certain state.

This ensures that the provider is in the right state or precondition to match the response that the consumer expects before the data provider verifies the contract. In figure 4.2, a provider state named “create user” is set up in the provider contract tests. This state will create the necessary data the consumer requires to ensure that when consumers send a `GET` request to retrieve a specific user, the correct data is always available. We’ll explain provider states in more detail in chapter 6.